AIR TECHNICAL INTELLIGENCE CENTER
UNITED STATES AIR FORCE
WRIGHT-PATTERSON AIR FORCE BASE
OHIO

29 AUG 1957

AFCIN-AE

SUBJECT: (U) Request for Information - Hopkinsville Incident 21 August 1955

TO: Commander
Campbell Air Force Base
ATTN: Intelligence Section
Ft. Campbell, Kentucky

1. This Center requests any factual data, together with pertinent comments regarding an unusual incident reported to have taken place six miles north of Hopkinsville, Kentucky on subject date. Briefly, the incident involved an all night attack on a family named [redacted] by goblin-like creatures reported to have emerged from a so-called "flying saucer."

2. The Air Force has been informed by reliable sources that an article on this incident may soon appear in a magazine publication, and that the Air Force will be queried regarding its opinion or explanation.

3. Lacking factual, confirming data, no credence can be given this almost fantastic report. As the incident has never been officially reported to the Air Force, it has not taken official cognizance of the matter. However, two important factors prompt this request:

a. Previous experience with sensational articles of this type show that almost invariably a large amount of inquiries and allegations against the Air Force soon follow, from both the press and public, and

b. An unconfirmed report stated that the affair was investigated and reported upon by two Air Force officers from Campbell Air Force Base. This Center, which is responsible for resolving incidents of this nature under provisions of AFR 200-2 "Unidentified Aerial Objects," has no knowledge of such reports.

4. To assist you with respect to any inquiries or investigations, the incident was investigated by the Kentucky State Patrol, the Sheriff's Office, and the Hopkinsville Police Department. The Chief of Police at that time was a [redacted], and is believed to still be in office.

FOR THE COMMANDER

William J. Thomas, CWO, USAF
for

WALLACE W. ELWOOD
Captain, USAF
Assistant Adjutant

B/L fr Air Technical Intelligence Center, Wright-Patterson AFB, Ohio, dtd 29 Aug 57, Subj: Req for Info - Hopkinsville Incident 21 Aug 55

BA (29 Aug 57) 1st Ind OCT 1 1957

4002d Air Base Squadron, Campbell Air Force Base, Fort Campbell, Kentucky

TO: Air Technical Intelligence Center, Wright-Patterson Air Force Base, Ohio

1. In reference to your request, the following information is submitted:

a. Captain Robert J. Hertell, former base adjutant, was contacted. He stated that to his knowledge, an official investigation was never ordered. A copy of his informal reply to the present base adjutant is enclosed. Captain Bennett was unable to give any additional information.

b. A statement given to thebase adjutant by Major Albert is inclosed. Inclosures 2 and 6 are referred to in this statement. Major John E. Albert is a reservist who participates in reserve training periods at this station.

c. A copy of a newspaper article that appeared in the Hopkinsville paper on the day following this incident is attached. Subsequent articles that were published by this newspaper added little, if any, information to that contained in the first article. Another article that was recently published by the same newspaper is inclosed.

d. The Sheriff's Office and the Hopkinsville Police Department were contacted. Neither had a report of investigation on file; however, Chief Greenwell had an informal file of newspaper articles and letters on this incident.

e. A search of base files failed to produce any record of correspondence regarding this matter.

2. Any future information that is secured on this incident will be forwarded to your headquarters.

FOR THE COMMANDER:

Charles N. Kirk

CHARLES N KIRK
1st Lt, USAF
Adjutant

6 Incls:
1. Ltr fr Capt Hertell
2. Statement ([redacted])
3. Copy of article in Hopkinsville Newspaper (22 Aug 55)
4. Copy of article in Hopkinsville Newspaper (11 Sep 57)
5. Statement given to Lt Kirk by Maj Albert
6. Copy of writing on Mrs [redacted]s article

Reply and later on results of investigation

COPY

3928TH AIR BASE SQUADRON (SAC)
United States Air Force
APO 237, New York, New York

17 September 1957

Dear Kirk:

I just returned from TDY today, and found your letter regarding the alledged "flying saucer" incident that occurred in Hopkinsville, Kentucky, on or about 21 August 1955.

I do remember this incident vaguely, but I'm afraid I can't help you much since I was not directly connected with it. That being the case, I am therefore answering your request in this informal manner and the following is, to the best of my knowledge, all that I know about the incident.

Prior to the above incident- several months earlier I beleive- we had another "flying saucer" report eminating from the Hopkinsville area. This earlier incident took place on the farm, (just south of Hopkinsville), of a Mr. [redacted], (I think his name was).

Briefly, Mr. [redacted] and a negro handy-man employed by him had observed an unidentified object streak across the sky, perform several abrupt changes of course, and finally disappear in the direction of Bowling Green, Kentucky. They observed this object for several minutes. I think that there was another witness or two present that were guests of Mr. [redacted] at the time. Since Mr. [redacted] was a very prominent citizen of the area, and the senior member of the largest local law-firm, and since the description of the object and its maneuvers was very accurate, some credence was lent to the story. We therefore reported this incident in accordance with AFR 200-2, by Confidential Message.

I mention the above preceding incident, (of which I have personal knowledge since I personally investigated it), because it preceeded, to the best of my knowledge, the S[redacted] incident. It was not long after the White incident that we heard of the [redacted] incident- perhaps the power of suggestion?

To my knowledge, the [redacted] incident was first investigated, and thoroughly so, by the State Highway Patrol, and later by the Sheriff's Office. The incident was never officially reported to the Air Force. In fact, the first I remember hearing about it is when several persons at Campbell brought to my attention an article about the incident which appeared in the local Hopkinsville paper.

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It should be an easy task to look back through the newspaper's files covering that period and find the article. The story was altogether too fantastic for even the newspaper to swallow, and they never did give it a very big play as I remember. It died a natural death a few days later. It never did reach national proportions, and for that matter, it did not, as far as I know, even receive state-wide coverage. Futhermore, the story became more exaggerated and more distorted with each new interview of the farmer and his family.

An interesting sidelight was the fact, told to me by several of the local authorities, that the farmer put up signs at the entrance to his property and was charging $1.00 per head, "to see where the Mars-Men landed".

As for the report that the affair was investigated and reported upon by two Air Force Officers from Campbell Air Force Base, I dont beleive that there is any fact in this. I beleive that a couple of our officers may have gone down-on their own- to view the place, as I heard some talk of this at the time, but Colonel Donald McPherson, the Base Commander certainly never ordered any official investigation, to the best of my knowledge.

I seem to remember Captain Benjamin Bennett saying something about going down to see the spot, but since he is still stationed there, surely you have already questioned him regarding this matter.

The only other officer who may have looked into this matter was the Deputy Base Commander, Major Ziba B. Ogden, now stationed at Westover Air Force Base. I remember the two of us talking about the incident, and he could possibly have been sent to the scene by Col. McPherson, in an unofficial capacity, without my knowing about it.

Thats about all I recall of the incident. At the time, Col. McPherson figured that there wasnt anything to it, and we all followed suit so to speak. There seemed to be nothing at all in the story that would in any way lend credance to it, so we all promptly forgot it.

In closing, Id like to point out, that out of all the cases that I investigated for the commander and out of all the incidents that happened around Campbell during my three and a half years there, this incident impressed me the least, and furthermore, I was never even remotely connected with it. It follows then, that my memory concerning this incident is rather faulty and I am not even sure exactly when it took place. Therefore Im afraid I havnt been of much help, and for this I apologize.

Sincerely,

CERTIFIED TRUE COPY: /s/ Robert J Hertell
/t/ ROBERT J HERTELL
Captain, USAF

Charles N. Kirk
CHARLES N KIRK
1st Lt, USAF
Adjutant